Xbox One (Credit: Flickr.com)

comes their way, with full glory of the graphics and performance. This calls for the most-upgraded Intel processor, a top-notch graphics card like GeForce GTX 1080 8GB or STRIX GTX 970, along with a lot of RAM power (at least 16GB), storage space of at least 4TB and a good cooling system. All this may cost ₹ 150,000 or more. This price may or may not include other peripherals like monitor, keyboard, mouse or speakers. It is preferable to get a custom-built desktop over a pre-built one for a better choice of internals.

Laptops have seen major improvements in terms of computing capacity. However, constriction in size and emphasis on portability restrain laptops from attaining the performance of desktops. Yet, the required miniaturisation keeps the cost of gaming laptops quite high. This is why the price you pay for a gaming laptop with specific configuration can fetch you a desktop of at least 30 per cent better specs.

To give you an idea, MSI GE 73VR gaming laptop that includes Intel i7 7th-generation processor, GeForce 1070 graphics card, 16GB RAM, 1TB storage and a full-HD screen costs above ₹ 180,000. And, Dell Alienware 15 with 32GB RAM and GeForce 1080 8GB video card is priced at ₹ 264,000 (approx.). Therefore laptops are the most expensive among all gaming setups.

Performance and longevity

This is where desktop PCs take the lead, essentially because of their flexibility to upgrade. A desktop can accept any scale of upgrade that is compatible, and evolve into a mightier system. This also ensures that a desktop system will never run obsolete. You can change or upgrade the RAM and then, after a year or two, upgrade the processor when it is old and so on, essentially letting you update your system step-by-step and stay relevant with time.

Moreover, the sheer space that a desktop provides the CPU gives the hardware enough room to breathe and perform much better. A desktop can integrate bigger coolers, too, keeping the system safer, making it live longer and take more load. With a good monitor system, a desktop CPU can run any game efficiently, even games at 4K resolution, if configured so.

Dell Alienware 15 R2 (Credit: www.mega.pk)

Gaming consoles are dedicated to one task only, that is, gaming. So, it is obvious that these run any game compatible with the console flawlessly, even at full specifications. New-generation consoles are improving, bringing out new devices that support 4K resolution gaming as well as other features like virtual reality (VR) gaming, kinect gaming and so on. This adds a variety to the style of games you can play on the console. However, it is found that performance-wise, a fully-configured gaming PC can outbeat a gaming console, even in high-end 4K gaming.

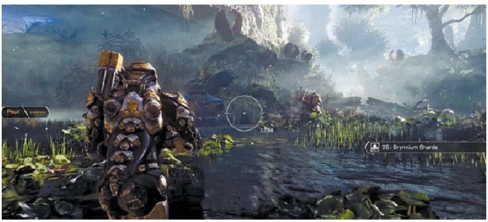
Additionally, gaming consoles go obsolete when the company pulls off its support for older models to introduce new ones. So, if you get PS4 for yourself, know that within five years, you need to start saving for PS5.

Laptops have brought in massive improvement in capacities. However, these are also not upgradable. While modern laptops have introduced expandable RAM and other parts, these do not equate with a desktop's capacity. Laptops also lag in cooling, since external coolers needed for laptops do not match the efficiency of an integrated cooling system. Therefore, after a certain threshold, laptops lose out to the capacity of a desktop. Moreover, once internal components become older and, eventually, obsolete, you will have to get a completely new system to stay updated. That is a major investment all over again.

Game roster

Both desktop and laptop computers have a certain edge over consoles in this aspect. Of course, you have many superb console-exclusive titles like Halo 5 for Xbox systems or Uncharted for PSes, which are the USP for consoles. Yet, computer systems give you access to a massive inventory of games, popular titles as well as Indie ones, which are not available for consoles. This large selection of games makes up for the lack of access to console-exclusive titles.

Gaming consoles have no backward-compatibility of games (that is, newer



Playing Anthem game in 4K (Credit: youtube.com)